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TEXT OF TELEGRAM 86STATE 311155

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C O N F I D E N T I A L STATE 311155

E.O. 12356: DECL:OADR
TAGS: PREL, UR, US
SUBJECT: SOVIET SPEAKING NOTE TO EUROPEANS
ON ICELAND MEETING

1. CONFIDENTIAL - ENTIRE TEXT.

2.

TO PROVIDE AN
UNOFFICIAL TRANSLATION OF A SOVIET SPEAKING NOTE ON
SOVIET "MOTIVES" BEHIND THEIR PROPOSAL FOR A MEETING
BETWEEN REAGAN AND GORBACHEV. IN REYKJAVIK, THE MESSAGE
WAS ORIGINALLY CONVEYED TO

3. BEGIN TEXT. IT HAS JUST BEEN ANNOUNCED THAT, BY
AGREEMENT, THE GENERAL SECRETARY OF THE CENTRAL COMMITTEE
OF THE CPSU, M.S. GORBACHEV, AND THE PRESIDENT OF THE
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USA, R. REAGAN, WILL MEET ON 1112 OCTOBER 1986 IN
REYKJAVIK (ICELAND). ON THE INSTRUCTION OF M.S.
GORBACHEV WE WOULD WISH TO INFORM YOU OF THE MOTIVES
LEADING TO THIS STEP AND THE BACKGROUND TO THE
ACHIEVEMENT OF THIS AGREEMENT.

THE PROPOSAL FOR AN EARLY CONFIDENTIAL MEETING - EITHER IN
ICELAND OR LONDON - WAS PUT FORWARD BY M.S. GORBACHEV IN
HIS PERSONAL MESSAGE TO R. REAGAN IN REPLY TO THE

PAGE NO.

DEPARTMENT OF STATE

PEALS REVIEW PANEL, DATE

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Responsive information

FOIA Exemptions (s)

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LATTER'S LETTER OF 25 JULY. THIS MESSAGE WAS RECENTLY HANDED OVER IN WASHINGTON TO THE PRESIDENT OF THE USA BY THE MINISTER OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS OF THE USSR, E. A. SHEVARONAOZE. THIS PROPOSAL AROSE FROM THE FACT THAT, HAVING ANALYSED THE COURSE OF THE NEGOTIATIONS IN GENEVA AND THE CONTENT OF REAGAN'S LETTER (MENTIONED ABOVE), THE SOVIET LEADERSHIP CAME TO THE CONCLUSION THAT THE WHOLE PROCESS OF SOVIET-AMERICAN DIALOGUE WAS IN NEED OF A SERIOUS IMPULSE. AT PRESENT THE NEGOTIATIONS ARE PRACTICALLY MARKING TIME, CREATING ONLY THE APPEARANCE OF CONSTRUCTIVE WORK. IT WAS ALSO TAKEN INTO ACCOUNT THAT THE OVERWHELMING MAJORITY OF RESPONSIBLE STATE LEADERS OF EAST AND WEST, THE MAJORITY OF GOVERNMENTS AND THE WORLD PUBLIC ARE INSISTENTLY COMING OUT IN FAVOUR OF THE HOLDING OF A SOVIET/AMERICAN SUMMIT MEETING.

THIS PROPOSAL OF OURS DOES NOT MEAN THAT THE VISIT OF M. S. GORBACHEV TO THE UNITED STATES, ON WHICH THERE WAS AGREEMENT AT THE GENEVA MEETING, IS BEING CANCELLED. BUT IN ORDER THAT IT SHOULD BE USEFUL, A CERTAIN CONFIDENCE IS NECESSARY THAT THIS VISIT WILL PRODUCE RESULTS.

OUR INITIATIVE WAS INTENSIVELY DISCUSSED IN THE CONTACTS BETWEEN E. A. SHEVARONAOZE AND G. SHULTZ IN WASHINGTON
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AND NEW YORK AND, DESPITE ALL THE COMPLICATING CIRCUMSTANCES, WHICH WERE NOT CREATED BY OUR SIDE, LEAD TO THE AGREEMENT WHICH HAS NOW BEEN MADE KNOWN.

THE SHORT BUT SUBSTANTIVE MEETING HAS THE TASK, IN OUR OPINION, OF INDICATING STEPS FOR THE SWIFT ELABORATION AT THE LEVEL OF RESPONSIBLE ORGANISATIONS OF DRAFT DOCUMENTS ON 23 KEY QUESTIONS OF DISARMAMENT, WHICH COULD BECOME THE SUBJECT OF NEGOTIATIONS AT THE SOVIET/AMERICAN SUMMIT MEETING IN WASHINGTON.

THE AGREEMENT REACHED REFLECTS, IN OUR VIEW, THE EVIDENT INTEREST EVERYWHERE IN THE WORLD, INCLUDING FROM YOUR SIDE, THAT THE MEETING OF THE LEADERS OF THE USSR AND THE USA SHOULD NOT SIMPLY TAKE PLACE BUT SHOULD LEAD TO SUBSTANTIVE AGREEMENTS ON THE MOST IMPORTANT DIRECTIONS FOR LESSENING THE NUCLEAR THREAT.

WE HOPE THAT YOUR COUNTRY, TO THE EXTENT OF ITS POSSIBILITIES, WILL FACILITATE THE FRUITFUL COURSE OF SOVIET/AMERICAN SUMMIT DIALOGUE AND THE GENERAL AMELIORATION OF THE WORLD POLITICAL CLIMATE. END TEXT.

3. COMMENT. THE CONTENTS OF THE SPEAKING NOTE SQUARE WITH OTHER SOVIET PUBLIC STATEMENTS ABOUT THEIR EXPECTATIONS FOR THE ICELAND MEETING AND ITS RELATIONSHIP TO A

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FOLLOW-ON SUMMIT IN THE U.S. THE MESSAGE IS EVIDENCE
THAT THE SOVIETS ARE GOING OUT OF THEIR WAY TO COURT THE
EUROPEANS ON THEIR WAY TO REYKJAVIK. END COMMENT. WHITEH.LAD

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